

Bhargav B S

Research Associate (Welfare)

Summary

Social science researcher working on welfare, inequality, and political economy in India, using quantitative methods and large-scale public datasets. Experience with quantitative analysis of survey and administrative data, qualitative fieldwork, and policy-oriented research on rights-based welfare programs.

Research Experience

- May 2025 – Present **Research Associate**, *Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy*, Azim Premji University
- **First authored** a paper comparing COVID-19 excess mortality across Indian states (under peer review).
 - Conducting quantitative and qualitative analysis of welfare regimes using primary fieldwork and secondary datasets.
 - **Editorial team** and conducted data analysis to seven chapters of a forthcoming *Handbook on Welfare in India*.
 - **Co-authoring** the chapter on the Mid-Day Meal programme.
 - Conducted preliminary field research on rural household indebtedness.
 - **First authoring** a working paper on adult height trends in India using DHS survey data.
- Apr 2022 – Dec 2024 **Research Assistant**, *Public Systems Group*, Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad
- Conducted policy research on urban service delivery, education policy, rural vulnerability, and cooperative institutions.
 - Led mixed-methods analysis integrating qualitative fieldwork with quantitative data.
 - Engaged with government agencies, NGOs, and community organisations for policy evaluation.
 - Drafted working papers, research reports, and opinion pieces on governance and education.
 - Reviewed implementation of major social policies including RTE Section 12(1)(c).
- Jun 2021 – Sep 2021 **Consultant**, *Nexus Consulting India*
- Conducted research and content development for the Telugu adaptation of *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?*
 - Verified and curated quiz content for factual accuracy and cultural relevance.

Education

- 2021 **Master of Arts in English**, *The English and Foreign Languages University*, Hyderabad
GPA: 8.38 / 9.00 (Letter Grade: O)
- 2019 **Bachelor of Arts in Communicative English, Political Science, Economics**, *St. Joseph's College (Autonomous)*, Bangalore
GPA: 7.75 / 10.00 (First Class Distinction)

Audited Coursework

- Doctoral **Analysing and Evaluating Educational Policy (AEEP)** (2022), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructor: Prof. Ankur Sarin
- Doctoral **Exploratory Data Visualisation (EDV)** (2023), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructor: Prof. Kavitha Ranganathan
- Doctoral **Using Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference in Social Policy (QMCISP)** (2024), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructors: Prof. Ankur Sarin, Prof. Ambrish Dongre
- MBA **Public Policy (PP)** (2023), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructor: Prof. Ankur Sarin
- MBA **Social Entrepreneurship: Innovating Social Change (SEISC)** (2023), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructors: Prof. Ankur Sarin, Prof. M. S. Sriram
- MBA **Social and Cultural Environment of Business (SCEB)** (2023), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Instructor: Prof. Ankur Sarin

Courses attended without formal enrolment or assessment; level of participation varied by course, with focus on sessions most relevant to my research.

Publications, Working Papers, and Research in Progress

Under Peer Review

Bhargav B S, Sinha, D., Jayadev, A. *Cross-State Comparison of Excess Deaths During the COVID-19 Pandemic in India: Measurement and Methodological Considerations*. Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. **Under Peer Review**. [Link]

Working Papers

Bhargav B S, Sinha, D., Jayadev, A. *Growth without Growth: The Puzzle of Indian Adult Heights*. Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. February 2026.

Bhargav B S, Sarin, A., Rajendra, A. *Collaboration and Co-creation in the Implementation of a Rights-Based Mandate: Case of the Right to Education Resource Center*.

Opinion Articles

Bhargav B. S., Jayadev, A. (2026). *The quiet demographic revolution unfolding in India The Hindu*. [Link]

Sarin, A., **Bhargav B S**. (2022). *Implications of the RTE Experience for EWS Quotas: Can Policy Goals be Considered Independently of Implementation? The India Forum*. [Link]

Teaching Case Study

Bhargav B S, Sarin, A. *Karnataka's Case of Right to Education Section 12(1)(c): Journey of a Rights-Based Policy*. (Draft in place for IIMA Case Centre)

White Paper

Bhargav B S, Chamola, B., Dave, M., Sarin, A., Rajendra, A. *A White Paper on the Potential of Multipurpose Cooperatives in the Urban Informal Sector*. (Forthcoming)

Conference Presentations

Formalizing the Urban Informal through Multipurpose Cooperatives. 18th ICA Asia-Pacific Research Conference, IIM Kozhikode (Oct 2024, Full Paper Accepted).

Claiming Rights: A Case of Voluntary Initiatives of the Excluded in Ahmedabad. 16th International Society for Third Sector Research (ISTR), University of Antwerp, Belgium (Jul 2024, Accepted).

Coproduction in the Delivery of Rights-Based Policies. International Research Society for Public Management, Tampere University, Finland (Apr 2024, Accepted).

Collaboration and Co-creation in the Implementation of a Rights-Based Mandate. India Public Policy Network Conference, IIM Ahmedabad (Dec 2022, Presented).

Methods and Skills

Methods	Mixed methods research; qualitative interviews and focus group discussions; analysis of secondary survey data; primary survey design and implementation; introductory causal inference and econometrics.
Data & Software	R, Stata, Python, SurveyCTO, Atlas.ti, Tableau, L ^A T _E X, VS Code
Academic	Research writing, policy analysis, conference presentations

Languages

English, Kannada, Telugu, Hindi

References

Dr. Dipa Sinha — Associate Professor, Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. dipa.sinha@apu.edu.in

Dr. Arjun Jayadev — Professor (Economics) and Director, Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. arjun.jayadev@apu.edu.in

Dr. Rajendran Narayanan — Associate Professor (Economics), School of Arts and Sciences and Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. rajendran.narayanan@apu.edu.in